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Andreessen Horowitz marketing maestro Margit Wennmachers is stepping down

By [Michael Bodley](#)

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[Andreessen Horowitz](#)'s Margit Wennmachers is "graduating" to emeritus partner, she announced on Wednesday.

Wennmachers hatched the famed venture firm's marketing approach from its earliest days, joining founders Marc Andreessen and Ben Horowitz in 2010. Over the years, a16z evolved from masterfully shaping its image in the press, to focusing on "going direct."

Wennmachers in a [LinkedIn post](#) said that "it's time," and she will take on an advisory role at Andreessen Horowitz for the next six months. There was no immediate word on whether the firm will fill her role after her departure.

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Wennmachers joined a16z in the aftermath of the 2008 financial crisis, which brought about a steep VC downturn.

"These guys were ballsy," she said of Andreessen and Horowitz in her LinkedIn note. "It was the height of the financial crisis, there was zero liquidity. Ben and Marc wanted to raise \$300m. Just the two of them. When probed on this, Marc just said, 'Let's assume success, shall we?'"

Her departure comes as a16z is doubling down on its direct messaging and marketing efforts. The firm in April [brought on content pro Erik Torenberg as general partner](#), acquiring Torenberg's podcast network, Turpentine, in the process.

The firm, meanwhile, is also [reportedly raising as much as \\$20 billion](#) to invest in US AI startups.

Before joining a16z, Wennmachers co-founded The OutCast Agency, which became an influential force in Silicon Valley public relations.

Wennmachers is not retiring. She writes that after ensuring "the change is smooth, in particular for the folks in our network who have a long-standing relationship," she'll be "looking for what's next."

She did not immediately return a request for comment.

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About [Michael Bodley](#)

Michael Bodley is a senior venture capital reporter at PitchBook News, covering top fund managers and developments affecting limited partners. Based in New York, Michael previously led TheStreet.com’s crypto coverage. He also reported for Hedge Fund Alert after breaking into journalism at the San Francisco Chronicle. Originally from Baltimore, Michael graduated from Elon University.

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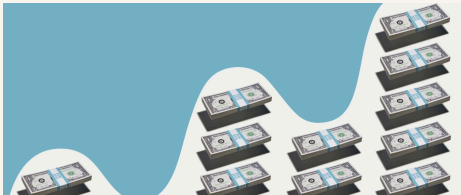


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